Learning demonstrating training event

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Swansea University
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Who are we.

Troy Astarte (they/them)

- Education busybody
- Office: CoFo 407
- Office hours: 1200 Monday / 1700 Friday (maybe online)
- `t.k.astarte@swansea.ac.uk`

Cécilia Pradic (she/her)

- Sent you emails
- Office: CoFo 410
- Office hours: 1400—1600 Monday
- `c.pradic@swansea.ac.uk`

Attendance & admin things

Cécilia has a **spreadsheet**.
Tell to her to record your attendance.
And log your hours on `fse-intranet.swansea.ac.uk`
To get paid some £

Demo time for fse-intranet

Admin to do **weekly** (in most cases).

If you were just hired, talk to her at end of session
Ditto if you want more work or something

You are already trained???

Note you already have some of this on canvas. It's called:

HUB: Faculty of Science and Engineering – Teacher Assistant Training

Cécilia finds part 2 quite excellent.

TL;DR Cécilia's view

Your module coordinators are adults, talk to them.

Conversely, "**adults**" are module coordinators in these slides

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Adults vary in attitude and disposition

Why are you being trained right now? (background)

According to the university, learning and teaching is made up of

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Keywords can be wielded by disgruntled students in the **NSS** to tarnish the good name of this institution.

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OK now maybe let us talk about real things.

Giving the right amount of help

When in doubt

Ask the adult in the lab (not you).

Things to think about:

- Fairness; avoid too long with one student (usually 5 mins)
- Be proactive in explaining things
- **Never** touch a student's keyboard / mouse
- Always start by asking a student to explain
- If you don't know, don't bullshit. Ask the adult. And listen to the explanation the adult is giving, that way you might learn something and be able to deal with the situation in the future.

Giving feedback to students on labs / coursework

When in doubt

Ask the adult in the lab (not you).

- If you don't know, don't bullshit; call adult for help.
- Feedback in lab is typically **your** job.
- Feedback for coursework **may** be your job. See with adult.
- Don't just say "No", offer avenues for development or explain why.
- No need to be a cop; that's an adult prerogative.
- what about suspicious behaviour? (later)

Doing useful work during quiet labs

- Try to appear available
- Begining of term: students might be shy, don't hesitate to engage with a smile
- Look out for puzzled / stressed / confused looking students and ask what they are doing
- Doing something else during a lab: please do not let that distract you from your feedbacking role.
- If you don't understand some of the module material, might be a good time to ask the adult to make you understand so that you can be more helpful.

Managing relationships with staff

- Try to warn them in advance if you're unavailable
- Tell them if you are confused
- You don't have to work outside of your paid hours
- They may write recommendation letters to you
- If you are asked to do something and you don't know if it is allowable, contact a super-adult (Cécilia)

What do do when students disclose personal situations

Don't be mean and don't gossip about it without their consent.

Exception

If they are at risk of immediate serious harm you are legally obliged to do *something* in this country. Informing security is probably standard (phone: 01792 604271 / 999).

If study-related, they should speak with the adult, not you.

Managing inappropriate student behaviour

Stay safe. Remove yourself from physical interactions.
Immediate physical danger, security (01792 604271 / 999)?

Inappropriate = abusive, disruptive

- If only mildly disruptive (e.g. noise), let them know and rectify their disruption before escalating.
- If not disruptive or doing something very illegal, whatever.
- If you don't feel comfortable signing them off, don't.

Tell an adult

- module coordinator
- relevant programme director (MSc: Trang Doan, UG: ????)

What if you think students are cheating?

- It's adults' prerogative to enforce **Academic Integrity**
- The code is very similar to that which you have seen before
- It is too advanced for the level of the module
- Student seems to understand
  - it's probably fine, maybe mention it to the adult
- Student cannot explain anything ("I've slept since then")
  - no sign-off
  - note down student number and inform the adult

Roleplay

Experienced TAs pair up with an unexperienced TA.

Lab Task: guess the secret number"

Implement a single-player game.
The program should repeatedly take an input $n \in \mathbb{N}$ from the player and say "higher" or "lower" until the guess is right.

Experienced TA:

- Download one sample answer at `https://cpradic.deuxfleurs.fr/tatraining/`
- Read it and obey the comments on top
- Pretend you are a student calling upon unexperienced TA

Unexperienced TA:

- Don't look at screen until Experienced TA asks you for something

What have we learned?

Thoughts? Comments? Questions?

The end

Stick around if you need to talk to Cécilia
Don't forget to have her record your attendance
Don't forget to log your hour next week on `CSTAT`
Feedback form `https://forms.office.com/e/pH39Pcnt7t`
Slides at `https://cpradic.deuxfleurs.fr/tatraining/`